Admissibility Theory of Consciousness

From Constrained Continuation to Reflexive Self-Situated Organization

Phenomenality remains an explicit bridge problem, not a property established by definition.

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Abstract

Consciousness debates often promote familiar capacities of human minds into necessary conditions while leaving the underlying organization unspecified. This paper proposes the Admissibility Theory of Consciousness (ATC): admissibility–the distinction between eligible and excluded continuations–as a candidate structural kernel around which consciousness-relevant organization develops. The claim is not that every constrained process experiences, but that sensing, meaning-binding, persistence, reflexivity, and situated agency can be investigated as different organizations of constrained continuation. Drawing on Dynatology, ATC distinguishes conceivable transitions, admissible transitions, and realized trajectories; separates physical feasibility, epistemic warrant, and authorization; and distinguishes context-sensitive behavior from alteration of the governing relation. Five organizational regimes connect elementary constraint to situated sensitivity, persistence, reflexive representation, and authorized self-authorship without imposing a scalar consciousness ranking. The Ableman Consciousness Ontology supplies multidimensional description; Semantic Reactor Theory supplies a proposed, inspectable architecture of epistemic positioning, governance, execution, and feedback; Meaning–Inertia remains an optional physical hypothesis. The paper locates these proposals within process philosophy, cybernetics, organizational closure, enactivism, and contemporary consciousness research. Its principal obligation is empirical discrimination: specifying which organizations of admissibility explain evidence beyond generic descriptions of lawful dynamics. Phenomenality remains an explicit bridge problem, not a property established by definition.

Keywords: admissibility; constrained continuation; consciousness; reflexivity; meaning-binding; organizational closure; Dynatology; Semantic Reactor Theory.

1. The admissibility thesis

> **Consciousness may not begin with awareness of a world. It may begin with admissibility–the primitive fact that, given a state, some continuations are admissible and others are excluded. What we recognize as cognition and consciousness may be progressively reflexive organization of that fact.**

The proposal moves the explanatory starting point below language, intelligence, self-narration, and introspective report. Rather than selecting one conspicuous human capacity as the essence of consciousness, it asks what those capacities organize: distinctions among possible continuations, the conditions that preserve those distinctions, and the processes through which a system becomes situated within them.

The word *begin* denotes explanatory priority, not an established evolutionary sequence or the first moment of experience. Similarly, an admissible continuation need not occur. Several alternatives may remain eligible while only one becomes actual. Exclusion is not equivalent to nonselection. This distinction prevents the account from treating every unrealized possibility as a refusal.

ATC makes three differently warranted commitments. Its **formal commitment** is that the transition structures developed in Dynatology can describe constrained continuation. Its **organizational hypothesis** is that meaningful distinctions, binding persistence, situated regulation, and reflexivity can be studied through transformations of those structures. Its **consciousness hypothesis** is that this organization provides a useful basis for discovering invariants associated with experience. The first does not prove the second; neither proves the third.

This is a foundational bridge rather than a completed psychophysical theory. The supplied ACO candidate begins with a causal-sensitivity kernel and meaning-binding. ATC proposes moving the explanatory starting point to admissibility, while retaining ACO's insistence on multidimensional organization and its separation of structural participation from phenomenal claims. That relocation is a new proposal of this paper, not a definition already established by the source manuscript [ACO, Section Section 2, 6, 9].

The broadness of the kernel is intentional but scientifically costly. Constrained continuation applies to many systems not ordinarily classified as conscious. Consequently, admissibility alone cannot distinguish the conscious from the nonconscious. The substantive question is whether particular organizations of admissibility explain consciousness-relevant differences that an undifferentiated appeal to complexity, responsiveness, or computation does not.

2. The minimal kernel: possibility, permission, and realization

2.1 The inherited formal object

Dynatology defines a system by

$$\mathcal{D} = (S, \Omega, A), \qquad A \subseteq \Omega \subseteq S \times S,$$

where S is a state space of instantiated configurations, Ω is a conceivability relation, and A is an admissibility relation. Its refusal relation and forward continuation field are derived:

$$R = \Omega \setminus A, \qquad F_A(s) = \{s' \mid (s, s') \in A\}.$$

These definitions are inherited from Dynatology, not introduced as ATC discoveries [D, Section Section 2–3, 9, 11]. A model must specify its domain, temporal resolution, and interpretation of states before these objects acquire empirical meaning.

ATC's proposed kernel is **instantiated constrained continuation**, represented by this relational structure. It is not the claim that every system shares an identical set A. Different systems have different states and transitions. The candidate invariant is the organizational form: continuation is conditioned by distinctions between admissible and excluded alternatives.

A description must earn its connection to a system. An observer can draw a restrictive graph around almost anything. ATC requires the represented constraints to correspond to mechanisms, counterfactual dependencies, or independently identifiable governing conditions. Otherwise the purported kernel is an artifact of the description rather than an explanatory feature of its target.

2.2 Admissibility is typed

Dynatology explicitly distinguishes physical, informational, and constitutional constraints [D, Section 8]. ATC retains that distinction and proposes more explicit notation for this bridge:

$$A_{\text{phys}}, \qquad \widehat{A}_{\text{epi},t}, \qquad A_{\text{auth},t}.$$

The first concerns physical feasibility. The second represents what current evidence warrants treating as feasible or established. The third concerns permission under a declared authority structure. An idealized effective action relation may intersect all three, but an operational agent generally acts through fallible estimates rather than direct access to physical truth.

A physically possible action can be unauthorized. An authorized action can be physically impossible. Insufficient evidence can justify deferral without establishing impossibility or prohibition. Accordingly, a governance refusal must not be redescribed as a law of nature, and physical resistance must not be credited with deliberation or normative authority.

This typing also clarifies the logic-gate analogy. Under its ideal operating model, an AND gate implements a fixed relation such as $y' = u \wedge v$. Output zero is a valid output, not the absence of an output; the excluded cases are combinations inconsistent with the gate relation. The gate illustrates constrained transformation. Calling it a minimal cognitive model is an interpretive analogy, not evidence of understanding or experience.

2.3 What an invariance claim amounts to

A structural invariant must specify the transformations under which it is preserved. For a bijection $\phi : S \to S'$ that preserves admissibility,

$$(s, s') \in A \iff (\phi(s), \phi(s')) \in A',$$

admissible paths correspond under ϕ. Reachability and existence of indefinitely continuing paths are consequently preserved. This is an inherited graph-level invariance, not a proof that physical realization, causal power, or phenomenality is preserved [D, Section Section 27–28]. Rates, probabilities, intervention behavior, and relevant physical variables may require additional structure.

Thus ATC separates a **shared structural kernel** from a **discriminating consciousness invariant**. The former supplies a common vocabulary; the latter would identify a property whose relation to consciousness survives independent tests. This paper proposes the first as a route toward discovering the second.

3. From admissibility to meaning, binding, and viable participation

3.1 A distinction changes the future

Dynatology defines structural meaning through a distinction Δ that changes admissibility, $A_\Delta \neq A$, and also offers a distributional formulation [D, Section 14]. ACO defines meaning as constraint relevance and binding as its persistence under transformation [ACO, Section 2.2]. These are related but not identical definitions. ATC proposes a translation between them rather than silently substituting one for the other.

Three events must be distinguished. A system can **move to another state** under a fixed relation. It can **update a representation** of that relation. Or a mechanism, configuration, or authorized amendment can **change the effective relation itself**. These events are not interchangeable.

For example, a thermostat can respond differently at different temperatures under an unchanged control law. Its relevant state includes the temperature and setpoint. The permitted continuations from those states differ, but the global rule need not have changed. Ordinary sensitivity therefore does not require constitutional amendment.

For comparative work, ATC proposes a broader measurement question: does an intervention on a distinction change the target's future transition distribution, available continuations, or represented constraints? The model should state which changes. A difference in probabilities with unchanged support is still a dynamical difference; a Boolean edge set alone would miss it. This is an explicit extension for ATC, not a claim that $A_\Delta \neq A$ captures every such case without qualification.

3.2 Binding is persistence, not a mysterious substance

On the proposed translation, a distinction is structurally consequential when it changes continuation in a specified sense. It is **bound** when that relevance persists across specified transformations or intervals. The claim becomes measurable only after the retained relation, perturbations, and persistence criterion are declared.

Meaning–Inertia uses closely related language for resistance to rebinding and proposes that physical inertia and gravitation are projections of a participation substrate [MI, Section Section 2–4]. ATC borrows the question of persistent constraint relevance, not the proposed physics. Nothing here derives mass, gravitation, spacetime, or conservation laws from admissibility.

A persistent constraint also need not be good for the system. A malfunction can persist. An imposed restriction can survive despite damaging a participant's options. Persistence, viability, legitimacy, and phenomenality therefore remain separate predicates.

3.3 Participation requires a domain-specific continuation criterion

Dynatology defines participants through admissible trajectories and a viability kernel V_A containing states from which indefinite admissible continuation exists [D, Section Section 12–13]. That existential definition is useful but weak: a self-loop can satisfy it. It does not by itself establish robustness, biological self-maintenance, or an ability to survive disturbance.

For ATC experiments, viability should therefore be supplemented by declared task bounds, resource conditions, and perturbation assumptions. A controller that can continue along one fortunate path is different from one that can maintain an operating region despite disturbances. This supplementation is a proposed operational requirement, not a revision of Dynatology's core definition.

The resulting bridge is conceptual rather than an automatic developmental ladder:

admissibility $\longrightarrow$ consequential distinctions $\longrightarrow$ binding persistence $\longrightarrow$ situated participation.

Each arrow names an additional explanatory task. None marks a demonstrated onset of experience.

4. Five regimes of admissibility organization

The labels A_0–A_4 below name **regimes**, not five different definitions of the relation A, measured levels of consciousness, or compulsory stages. They are proposed coordinates for comparing organizations. A system may combine some features while lacking others.

4.1 $A0$: Bare admissibility

A mechanism instantiates constrained continuation without requiring a representation of its constraints. The ideal logic gate is a limiting example. This regime supplies a formal floor but no criterion of cognition, agency, or phenomenality. A printed truth table describes the same logical relation without necessarily implementing the same physical mechanism.

4.2 $A1$: Situated admissibility

Environmental or internal distinctions condition which continuations are available or selected. A thermometer and a fixed-rule thermostat illustrate different kinds of sensitivity at this level. Their changing response need not mean their global governing relation changes. Disturbance sensitivity, selectivity, and feedback should be measured separately rather than bundled into an unexplained word such as awareness.

4.3 $A2$: Persistent and viability-relevant admissibility

Feedback and retained state sustain a continuing organization. Stronger forms involve processes that maintain conditions on which their own operation depends. This connects to organizational closure, where constraints contribute to one another's maintenance rather than merely forming a circular signal path [Montevil and Mossio, 2015].

ATC distinguishes externally sustained persistence from such mutual maintenance. A repeatedly invoked component may persist as part of a larger system without maintaining itself. Neither form is disqualified in advance; the dependency structure determines the description.

4.4 $A3$: Reflexive admissibility

A system contains a causally operative representation $\widehat{A}_t$ of relevant constraints or continuation possibilities. It can use that representation to alter inference,

planning, refusal, or action. For this regime, producing sentences about rules is insufficient. Interventions on the representation should change relevant behavior in the predicted way.

ACO's meta-binding provides the source concept: constraints become representable objects [ACO, Section 9.2]. ATC adds an intervention criterion for distinguishing operative representation from an observer's interpretation or an unused report. The representation can be inaccurate; reflexivity is not omniscience.

4.5 *A4*: Authorized self-authoring admissibility

A participant can propose or enact changes to selected governing constraints under an amendment rule. It may revise a plan, renegotiate a commitment, or modify an internal policy within its authority. This is not the ability to escape physical law, acquire unlimited authority, or authorize itself merely by making a proposal.

ACO distinguishes meta-binding from epistemic autonomy [ACO, Section 9.2]. ATC preserves that distinction: representing a constraint does not entail permission to change it. External approval and partial authorship remain possible. Self-authorship is an organizational capability, not a necessary condition imposed on every conscious being.

These regimes should ultimately be described by profiles of sensitivity, persistence, integration, closure, representation, stake coupling, and amendment capacity. ACO's manifold language motivates this non-scalar treatment. Until a mathematical atlas or equivalent formal structure is supplied, *manifold* remains an organized multidimensional description rather than a proven differentiable manifold.

5. Invariant versus variant dimensions

The invariant/variant method asks whether a proposed requirement survives comparisons that alter the familiar human package. ACO makes this a central discipline [ACO, Section 6]. Language, inner speech, particular imagery, autobiographical narration, and ordinary self/world partitioning are not to be declared necessary merely because they are salient to an investigator.

There is direct evidence that reported inner-speech experience varies substantially. Nedergaard and Lupyan's four studies compared adults reporting low and high inner speech and found differences on some verbal tasks, not all tested tasks [Nedergaard and Lupyan, 2024]. These findings motivate decomposition of capacities. They do not identify the physical invariant of consciousness or establish a prevalence estimate for complete absence of inner speech.

A proposed necessity claim has the form $C \Rightarrow X$. A credible conscious case without X challenges it. A sufficiency claim has the reverse form and requires different evidence. Showing that an elementary device possesses a candidate

feature defeats its discriminatory value only if the feature was supposed to be sufficient. It does not automatically disprove its necessity.

This distinction repairs a recurring ambiguity around the thermometer. Sensitivity or admissibility can be present below sophisticated cognition and still be part of a broad common substrate. What their ubiquity prevents is using their mere presence as a decisive classification test.

Altered-state reports provide a related but limited method. The ACO candidate proposes studying experiences in which self-narration or ordinary boundaries are reportedly reduced [ACO, Section 6.3]. ATC treats those reports as evidence to investigate, not proof that underlying neural computation, self-regulation, memory formation, or integration has disappeared. **Phenomenological subtraction is not automatically architectural ablation.** A reported feeling of unity neither proves universal experience nor establishes that the system has become structurally simple.

This discipline must also constrain ATC itself. It cannot replace one human privilege with a new requirement for explicit rule representation, governance, or self-authorship. Reflexivity is a research hypothesis about organization; its particular forms remain candidates, not certified prerequisites.

Comparisons should independently assess the capacity being changed, the remaining evidence of experience, and the intervention's wider effects. Failure to report can reflect altered reporting machinery. Successful reporting can reflect training or task strategy. Neither observation should silently become the definition of the target phenomenon.

6. Closure, physical underwriting, and the system boundary

6.1 Three different meanings of closure

ATC distinguishes **feedback closure**, where a signal or effect returns to influence a later cycle; **organizational closure**, where processes or constraints contribute to maintaining one another; and **governance closure**, SRT's requirement that binding effects participate in decomposable governance traces [SRT, Section Section 4, 9]. These concepts can overlap, but none entails the others without additional assumptions.

This separation follows the difference between a loop and an organization that maintains its loop. Work on closure of constraints explicitly distinguishes ongoing processes from relatively conserved constraints operating at selected timescales [Montevil and Mossio, 2015]. A software feedback diagram does not establish that stronger property simply by containing a return arrow.

6.2 The system does not originate itself

The ACO candidate separates physical underwriting from persistent organization [ACO, Section Section 3–4]. ATC retains that separation. Energy supply,

activation, memory retention, and environmental support can enable an operating regime without each being sufficient to constitute whatever organization is under investigation.

The battery analogy is useful only within this boundary. A starter can initiate a process; continuing resources and mechanisms maintain it. The analogy supplies no missing phenomenal ingredient. Neither organizational closure nor autocatalysis should be interpreted as creation without resources or prior conditions.

In a model, relevant support variables must be included or explicitly treated as boundary conditions. A transition may cease to be feasible when a resource is absent even though the control policy is unchanged. Ordinary physical support is required whether or not Meaning–Inertia is correct; that optional hypothesis is not needed to explain that an unpowered implementation stops operating.

6.3 Component and composite are different targets

A consciousness-relevant predicate must be evaluated at a justified causal scale. ACO already states that a model component may lack properties found in an orchestration containing memory, scheduling, sensing, action, and feedback [ACO, Section Section 4.2, 10]. Dynatology provides a formal vocabulary for coupled systems and joint admissibility [D, Section 22].

ATC therefore rejects both automatic component reduction and arbitrary system enlargement. An absent loop within one transformer invocation says little about a loop completed by the surrounding orchestration. Conversely, connecting components on a diagram does not establish an integrated participant. Boundary evidence should identify dependencies, retained state, intervention effects, and the timescale on which the proposed organization exists.

Physical support and constitutive participation are explanatory roles, not immutable lists of components. A scheduler may merely activate an otherwise complete routine, or its timing may organize a crucial feedback process. The relevant test is what the proposed mechanism loses when the component or coupling is selectively changed.

7. Semantic Reactor Theory as a constructive model

7.1 The source architecture

SRT defines a semantic reactor through semantic inputs, authority-mediated admissibility, and externally binding effects. It explicitly distinguishes this class from an ordinary calculator or the engine used as an analogy [SRT, Section Section 2–3]. ATC does not expand that definition to include every logic gate.

Its formal roles and trace are

$$\mathcal{S} = (\mathcal{W}, \mathcal{G}, \mathcal{E}), \qquad \tau = (EP, GR, ER),$$

with the loop

$$\mathcal{W} \xrightarrow{EP} \mathcal{G} \xrightarrow{GR} \mathcal{E} \xrightarrow{ER} \mathcal{W}.$$

The Steward maintains the epistemic position; the Governor evaluates admissibility under authority; the Executor produces effects and an execution receipt. The artifacts are, respectively, EpistemicPosition, GovernanceReceipt, and ExecutionReceipt [SRT, Section 4]. This paper preserves those source terms rather than treating later interface names as replacements.

7.2 The proposed ATC interpretation

The Steward produces a bounded account of state, evidence, and uncertainty. It need not enumerate the world's complete possibility space. The Governor applies a declared rule to that account and a proposed continuation. It does not necessarily change the constitution whenever it makes a decision. The Executor attempts an admitted effect, subject to actual conditions. Its receipt records what is observed or established about that attempt, and the next Steward pass can incorporate the result.

This is a proposed constructive model of recursive admissibility: consequences of earlier decisions can alter the evidence and constraints relevant to later decisions. The loop, not the Governor alone, is the relevant organization. The source provides an architecture and illustrative trace; it is not by itself an empirical demonstration of a running ATC system or consciousness.

7.3 A worked analytical trace

Consider a governed artifact publisher. A candidate file may replace the current release only when its identity is verified, the replacement is authorized, and the current release still matches the version against which approval was given. This is an ATC illustration, not a reported implementation test.

The Steward emits EP_t: candidate digest verified; current release identified; approval evidence present; external changes since observation unknown. The Governor issues GR_t admitting replacement **conditional on** the current-release precondition still holding at execution. The Executor checks that precondition through an enforcement mechanism designed to avoid a check/use gap.

If the precondition holds, execution can proceed and ER_t records the observed result. If another process has changed the release, the Executor refuses the stale operation and produces a refusal receipt. The next epistemic position incorporates the changed release and the failed precondition. A renewed proposal may then be considered.

The second path matters. Refusal is not the absence of a system transition: it can update evidence, preserve a protected state, and redirect future action.

Nor does the first path guarantee success merely because permission existed. Authorization, attempted execution, and witnessed effect are distinct.

7.4 What instrumentation can and cannot establish

SRT's SRSA vector measures whether governance dimensions are instrumented, declared, and measurable. It is not a measure of phenomenal consciousness or moral worth [SRT, Section Section 4, 7, 13]. External legibility also does not automatically imply internal reflexivity. An unused log can make a process visible to an auditor while doing nothing to its next decision.

ATC would therefore test whether changing a represented constraint or withholding a receipt changes the next cycle as predicted. A receipt's existence is not proof of its truth, and a self-report is not an independent effects witness. Instrumentation needs declared trust boundaries and checks against effects outside the system's own narrative.

SRT describes ungoverned effects as unable to advance governed lineage [SRT, Section 5]. ATC preserves that lineage distinction but adds an explicit boundary condition: physically occurring, unauthorized effects can still affect later observations and must be representable as anomalies. Loss of legitimate lineage must not be mistaken for disappearance from reality.

Likewise, ATC uses SRT's role separation as a design commitment, not a universal theorem that shared hardware prevents inspectable artifacts. Its constructive question is whether interfaces, authority scopes, receipts, and feedback remain distinguishable and effective. It does not import every structural result in SRT as an independently verified theorem.

8. Phenomenality as the open boundary

ATC distinguishes an observable organizational description from the existence and character of experience. The former can be studied without first classifying every target as conscious or nonconscious. It must not then be presented as having settled the latter.

Let $\mathcal{O}_A$ denote a declared profile of admissibility organization and P denote the target phenomenological property. The proposed bridge remains

$$\mathcal{O}_A \overset{?}{\longleftrightarrow} P.$$

A future theory must specify the relevant organization, the kind of correspondence, and the evidence capable of challenging it. Calling an internal representation a *phenomenal rendering* is a hypothesis, not an explanation of why it feels like anything. The question concerns phenomenal character whatsoever, not whether a system reproduces a human inventory of colors, emotions, or inner speech.

The same boundary clarifies the relation to panexperientialism. Whitehead's mature process metaphysics treats actual occasions as experiential, while distinguishing primitive experience from reflective consciousness [Whitehead, 1929; Desmet and Irvine, 2022, Section 6]. ATC selectively adopts a process-relational research orientation without adopting ubiquitous experience. This is a departure from Whitehead's metaphysical package, not a claim to reproduce his system minus an optional decoration.

Panpsychism is not thereby dismissed as mystical or refuted. Its fundamental-experience commitment is simply not required by ATC. Universal constraint or causal participation does not independently establish universal phenomenality. Equally, ATC has not proved that experience is absent at elementary scales. Its present stance is **causal and organizational continuity without assumed phenomenal continuity**.

Under this formulation, the word *kernel* names a common structural starting point. A stronger thesis identifying admissibility itself with experience would be a different, additional identity claim. This paper does not rely on it.

9. Intellectual lineage and the manuscript family

9.1 Inherited problems, not a claim of first discovery

ATC does not introduce state-transition relations, feedback, viability, self-maintenance, or the idea that consciousness depends on organization. Ashby's cybernetics already provides a substrate-spanning vocabulary of transformation, regulation, and variety [Ashby, 1956]. The relevance is direct: a general description must distinguish what a system can do from the regulation that preserves selected conditions. ATC's primitive is indebted to that tradition, not a replacement for it.

Maturana and Varela's autopoiesis and later closure-of-constraints work address the organization through which living systems maintain their conditions of existence [Maturana and Varela, 1980; Montevil and Mossio, 2015]. The enactive tradition connects cognition to embodied activity and environmental coupling [Varela, Thompson, and Rosch, 1991/2017]. ATC uses these as neighboring accounts of persistence and situated organization while leaving their stronger commitments about life and mind distinct.

The ACO lineage also locates physical underwriting in the dissipative-structures tradition associated with Prigogine and identifies recurrent-processing theory as a relevant consciousness proposal [ACO, Section Section 14.2, 14.6]. These are inherited lineage pointers here, not new claims to derive thermodynamics or conscious perception.

More directly, IIT 4.0 proposes physical postulates derived from properties of experience and identifies experience with specified intrinsic cause–effect structure [Albantakis et al., 2023]. ATC does not adopt that identity or its measure.

Laukkonen, Friston, and Chandaria's active-inference proposal develops a recursive relation between a reality model and the system that constructs it [Laukkonen et al., 2025]. That is an important close precedent for reflexivity, not evidence that ATC discovered recursive world-modeling.

These are conceptual intersections, not a linear historical genealogy. ATC's proposed contribution is the specific organization of typed admissibility, invariant/variant comparison, system-boundary analysis, and an artifact-level constructive model. Establishing originality more broadly would require a systematic literature review; this paper makes no priority claim.

9.2 A dependency map, not compulsory restructuring

The manuscript family has four distinct roles. **Dynatology** supplies the general grammar of possibility and continuation. **ACO** supplies the multidimensional vocabulary of consciousness-relevant organization. **SRT** supplies a governance-specific architecture through which some of that organization can be externalized and tested. **Meaning–Inertia** proposes a possible physical substrate for binding persistence [D, Section Section 3, 14; ACO, Section Section 2, 9; SRT, Section 4; MI, Section Section 2–4].

ATC connects those roles without making them mutually validating. Its central bridge is

$$\text{Dynatology} \longrightarrow \text{ATC} \longleftrightarrow \text{ACO}, \qquad \text{SRT} \longleftrightarrow \text{ATC}.$$

Meaning–Inertia is an optional physical branch, not a premise on this path. A failure of that hypothesis would not by itself invalidate transition modeling, ACO's comparison method, or an SRT implementation. Likewise, a working reactor would not confirm an inertia hypothesis or establish phenomenal consciousness.

This division proposes how the papers can relate; it does not retroactively amend their definitions. In particular, Dynatology's distinction-sensitive meaning, ACO's constraint relevance, and SRT's externally binding semantic effects are not identical uses of *meaning* or *binding*. ATC connects their structural roles while retaining their different scopes.

10. Research program and conditions of failure

10.1 From a broad kernel to a discriminating model

The immediate requirement is a declared model: state variables, interventions, temporal grain, admissibility type, uncertainty treatment, and observed outputs. Without these, almost any result can be redescribed as admissibility and the thesis loses empirical content.

The primary structural hypothesis is that organizations differing in causally operative constraint representation and feedback will differ predictably under

matched perturbations, even when their initial task outputs agree. Testing this does not require a consciousness verdict. It tests whether the proposed organizational distinctions are more than renamed component lists.

Three model commitments should be fixed in advance: which internal or external variable represents a constraint; which intervention should change its relevance; and which later decisions or effects should respond. A prediction that changes after the outcome is inspected does not establish explanatory leverage. The same discipline applies when a model appears to fit human reports: interpretation of the report and interpretation of the mechanism must not be adjusted together until agreement is guaranteed.

10.2 Matched reactor interventions

A proposed first experiment compares the same task and proposal mechanism in four conditions: intact receipt feedback; feedback recorded but unavailable to the next Steward pass; a declared constraint representation disconnected from decision-making; and stale execution preconditions that are either enforced or ignored. The interventions are a design proposal; all experimental results remain **NOT RUN**.

Outcomes should include precondition violations, discrepancy-detection rate, recovery after changed constraints, correctness of refusal or deferral, and causal influence of the explicit representation on subsequent choices. Preserve inputs, randomness where applicable, resource budgets, and task difficulty across conditions. Include the latency and storage costs of instrumentation.

A genuine result may be conditional. Receipts might improve recovery only when the task requires history; an explicit constraint model might add nothing when a fixed controller already solves the task. Those outcomes would delimit the useful regime rather than justify a universal superiority claim. An external trace that changes no later inference would support auditability but not the internal reflexivity hypothesis.

10.3 Human comparisons and phenomenal bridge tests

A separate research track would compare reported experience and independently measured capacities across naturally occurring variation and appropriately governed studies. ATC's proposed measures would have to predict something beyond task difficulty, arousal, reporting demands, or general performance. Structural tests in an artificial reactor cannot substitute for that bridge.

Before interpreting a successful association, specify whether the target is the presence of experience, its contents, access for report, or metacognitive judgment. These are not interchangeable outcomes. A theory explaining improved constraint-sensitive reporting has not thereby explained phenomenal presence.

The bridge also needs matched negative controls. A richly instrumented system can display all of a proposed governance signature without that signature inde-

pendently establishing experience. Conversely, reduced explicit reporting in a human condition need not establish the absence of the relevant internal organization. The comparison should be designed to expose both kinds of mistaken inference.

10.4 What would weaken or defeat the proposal?

The universal-kernel claim is too broad to earn support from every ordinary constrained process. Scientific risk belongs to its specified extensions. An operational ATC model is weakened if its supposed constraint representations have no causal role, its boundary changes are arbitrary, or its measures merely reproduce existing metrics without improving explanation or prediction.

A proposed phenomenal criterion is challenged if credible experience persists when that criterion is absent, if the criterion appears in well-supported nonconscious conditions without the predicted distinction, or if an independent physical variable explains the observations while its stipulated admissibility description does not. Such findings target the declared model, not every possible future use of the word admissibility.

An implementation failure also matters. If a claimed enforcement boundary permits disallowed effects, or receipts systematically diverge from independently witnessed outcomes, the constructive model has failed its own declared requirement. That failure should remain visible rather than being removed from analysis as an ungoverned non-event.

The strongest negative outcome would be that ATC supplies a coherent translation among the manuscripts but no additional predictive leverage. It would then remain a comparative ontology, not an established theory of consciousness. The framework should permit that verdict.

11. Full Realization Funnel

ATC separates its theory from particular experiments and implementations through the full corpus funnel:

$$
\begin{aligned}
& P \\
& \to S \\
& \to CM_1 \\
& \to CM_2 \\
& \to IC \\
& \to IR \\
& \to E \\
& \to R
\end{aligned}
\quad .
$$

- **Possibility:** every conceivable account of admissibility organization and consciousness, including contradictory, trivial, harmful, unfalsifiable, and physically unrealizable variants.
- **Specification:** the target system boundary, temporal grain, state variables, admissibility type, constraint representation, interventions, phenomenal target, evidence contract, authority, refusal conditions, and falsifiers.
- **Configuration Manifold 1 (CM1):** all configurations satisfying the mandatory specification. CM1 may retain scientifically weak or undesirable variants when the specification has not excluded them.
- **Configuration Manifold 2 (CM2):** configurations preferred under declared epistemic and ethical criteria, such as discriminating power, causal identifiability, minimal anthropocentric loading, subject protection, reproducibility, and explicit uncertainty.
- **IC:** a selected **Instance Constitution** or **Instance Configuration** for a named model, reactor, organism study, or comparison. Both expansions name the same stage.
- **IR:** the concrete **Instance Realization** or **Implementation Realization** of that IC. Both expansions name the same stage; the wording alone changes no standing.
- **Evidence:** registered observations, interventions, reports, negative controls, effects witnesses, and claim ceilings.
- **Revision:** changes to definitions, boundaries, hypotheses, configurations, or experiments with predecessor lineage retained.

The A_0-A_4 regimes are comparison coordinates inside the theory; they are not themselves the CM1/CM2/IC/IR stages. A reactor design may occupy Specification or IC, running code may occupy IR, and a trace may become Evidence only under a declared observation and custody contract.

12. Corpus Placement and Non-Identity Boundaries

ATC is an integrative bridge, not a replacement for its source or neighboring works.

1. **Dynatology** supplies the general possibility/admissibility/realization grammar. ATC applies it to consciousness research; successful application would not validate all of Dynatology, and Dynatology does not entail ATC.
2. **Ableman Consciousness Ontology (ACO)** supplies multidimensional and invariant/variant comparison. ATC proposes admissibility as a lower-level kernel. They remain distinct papers and potentially competing organizations of the same research territory.
3. **Meaning as Binding** and **The Locus of Meaning** develop stronger semantic-binding accounts. ATC's continuation-sensitive distinction is an interface to those theories, not proof that every causal constraint is semantic meaning.
4. **The Locus of Qualia** examines where phenomenal character is located.

ATC's organization profile may supply candidate conditions, but neither paper closes the phenomenal bridge for the other.

5. **Semantic Reactor Theory (SRT)** supplies a constructive governance architecture. SRT instrumentation can test some ATC organizational claims but cannot establish consciousness merely by exhibiting a trace.
6. **The Well-Governed Mind** describes agent-level constitutional governance. A governed mind can be studied with ATC, but governance quality, agency, intelligence, and consciousness remain separate predicates.
7. **Meaning-Inertia** is an optional physical hypothesis. Its success or failure neither automatically proves nor defeats the structural ATC program.

The correct relations are typed dependencies such as `USES_GRAMMAR_FROM`, `APPLIES_METHOD_FROM`, `PROPOSES_KERNEL_FOR`, `OFFERS_TESTBED_FOR`, `SHARES_BOUNDARY_WITH`, and `COUNTERTESTS`. Lexical overlap or manuscript-family placement does not establish identity, derivation, endorsement, or truth.

13. Governed Meaning Base and Universal GSM Projection

The **Governed Meaning Base (GMB)** is the current name in the author-confirmed `CCF -> CMB -> GMB` lineage. GMB can preserve competing ATC specifications, system boundaries, regime assignments, experiments, observations, phenomenological reports, evidence standing, counterevidence, and revisions. It is not a consciousness detector, conscious subject, phenomenal witness, or authority empowered to classify moral standing.

The universal GSM should distinguish at least: target system, component, composite, environment, state, transition, possibility relation, admissibility relation, refusal relation, realized trajectory, distinction, constraint, binding, persistence interval, viability criterion, boundary, feedback closure, organizational closure, governance closure, representation of admissibility, amendment authority, regime assignment, phenomenological target, observation, self-report, independent witness, intervention, negative control, claim, claim ceiling, counterevidence, and revision.

High-value relations include `CONSTRAINS`, `EXCLUDES`, `REALIZES`, `REPRESENTS`, `CAUSALLY_INFLUENCES`, `PERSISTS_UNDER`, `MAINTAINS`, `PART_OF`, `BOUNDARY_DEPENDS_ON`, `ASSIGNED_REGIME_BY`, `TESTED_BY`, `REPORTED_BY`, `WITNESSED_BY`, `SUPPORTED_BY`, `COUNTEREVIDENCED_BY`, and `SUCCEEDS`. Each consequential relation requires source or evidence basis, origin class, scope, standing, and revision identity. A graph edge can record a consciousness claim; it cannot make the target conscious.

A Graded Structural Research Program, Not a Phenomenality Verdict

Across the completed P1 corpus, Admissibility Theory of Consciousness (ATC) is best placed as a **graded structural research program about self-situated admissibility organization**. It asks whether increasingly reflexive systems model, preserve, evaluate, and revise the conditions of their own continuation. It does not establish that admissibility is sufficient for consciousness or that a functionally similar machine is phenomenal.

- **Adjacent work:** *Continuation Primacy*
  Supplies: The general analytical priority of continuation conditions.
  ATC boundary: Continuation is a candidate structural prerequisite, not a consciousness criterion by itself.
- **Adjacent work:** *Dynatology*
  Supplies: Possibility, admissibility, realization, and constraint vocabulary.
  ATC boundary: Dynatology supplies the general possibility grammar; ATC applies a graded self-situated profile.
- **Adjacent work:** *The Well-Governed Mind*
  Supplies: Cognitive governance, self-model revision, and bounded agency.
  ATC boundary: Governance can operationalize tests without proving experience.
- **Adjacent work:** *Mainstream Consciousness Discourse as Lexical Disambiguation Failure*
  Supplies: Separation of overloaded consciousness vocabularies and targets.
  ATC boundary: ATC must name which target each result bears on rather than inherit a broad label.
- **Adjacent work:** *Technical Brief: Context-Compiled Consciousness Mode for Language Models*
  Supplies: A bounded functional mode produced through governed context.
  ATC boundary: A context-induced behavioral profile is an implementation hypothesis, not evidence of phenomenality.

The A_0 through A_4 ladder should be read as a measurement program over separable variables, not a single ascent to consciousness. A study object can be represented as:

$$\begin{aligned} C = (&continuation, viability, binding, self_model, \\ &reflexivity, authorization, phenomenal_report,. \\ &underwriting) \end{aligned}$$

Observed strength on one coordinate cannot be silently transferred to another. In

particular: persistence is not viability; viability regulation is not agency; agency is not authorized self-authorship; self-report is not independent phenomenality evidence; and functional organization is not proof of subjective experience.

The empirical program therefore needs matched countermodels. For each claimed ATC level, compare systems that reproduce the observable profile through simpler feedback, memorized reports, external scaffolding, evaluator leakage, optimization pressure, or interface theater. Ablate self-model access, cross-time binding, counterfactual evaluation, authorization, and physical feedback separately. A result supports only the distinctions that survive these rival explanations.

The universal GSM can type
`ORGANIZES_ADMISSIBILITY`, `PERSISTS_UNDER`,
`MAINTAINS_VIABILITY`, `MODELS_SELF_AS`, `REFLEXIVELY_EVALUATES`, `AUTHORIZED_TO_REVISE`,
`REPORTS_PHENOMENALITY`, `PHYSICALLY_UNDERWRITTEN_BY`, `RIVAL_EXPLAINED_BY`,
and
`DEFEATED_BY_ABLATION`. These relations prevent one lexical label from collapsing the full research surface.

This integration establishes four editorial commitments: adopt graded structural research program as ATC's official corpus role; adopt the separable-coordinate study object; require matched rival explanations and coordinate-wise ablation; and hold every phenomenality or machine-consciousness conclusion behind a distinct evidence and author-review gate.

Domain-Typed Admissibility and Research-Lifecycle Boundary

The fixed-seed neighborhood includes Admissibility Engineering, an international-trade UGK profile, Governance Incentive Engineering, and the Governed Knowledge Loop. It is therefore a useful test of whether randomized integration can preserve nonrelations rather than manufacture a universal theory.

An ATC research transition should bind:

$$\begin{aligned} T = (&target, system_boundary, admissibility_type,\\ &operationalization, rival_explanations, intervention,.\\ &evidence, corpus_state, decision, remainder) \end{aligned}$$

Admissibility Engineering concerns whether a named implementation path satisfies a declared requirement. ATC concerns graded structural hypotheses about continuation, viability, self-modeling, reflexivity, and authorized self-revision. Engineering admission or refusal does not establish an ATC regime, and ATC vocabulary does not supply software conformance.

The international-trade and governance-incentive works have no direct evidentiary bearing on phenomenality or the ATC structural ladder. Their presence in the

fixed-seed window is recorded as
`NO_MATERIAL_RELATION`, not converted into analogy. This protects the corpus from semantic overbinding.

The Governed Knowledge Loop can manage ATC hypotheses, rival explanations, ablations, evidence, revision, refusal, and decrystallization. It cannot decide consciousness, authorize experiments, or promote an attractive structural account without the distinct empirical and author gates already required by this paper.

The universal GSM can type
`DECLARES_ADMISSIBILITY_DOMAIN`,
`DISTINGUISHES_ENGINEERING_FROM_ATC`, `RECORDS_NO_MATERIAL_RELATION`,
`MANAGES_ATC_HYPOTHESIS_LIFECYCLE`, `RETAINS_RIVAL_EXPLANATION`,
`DECRYSTALLIZES_UNSUPPORTED_ATC_CLAIM`, and
`WITHHOLDS_PHENOMENALITY_VERDICT`.

This randomized review establishes four editorial commitments: adopt the typed ATC research-transition object; preserve the engineering/ATC terminology firewall; explicitly retain two neighborhood nonrelations; and use GKL only for governed hypothesis lifecycle, never as consciousness evidence.

A Consciousness Research Program with an Inference Firewall

Ten retained downstream uses place ATC among admissibility engineering, lexical disambiguation, Dynatology, incentive design, Meta-Binding, qualia research, Terminability, knowledge governance, meaning, and the Locus of Qualia. They support ATC as a graded structural research target. They do not support an admissibility score for consciousness, a phenomenal verdict, a moral-status classifier, or the transfer of authorization vocabulary from governance into a claim that a system authors its own legitimate authority.

The research case is:

$$\begin{aligned} C^* = (&target_identity, boundary, substrate, environment,\\ &admissibility_regime, persistence, viability,\\ &reflexivity, self_model, self_modification,\\ &governance_relation, interventions, measures, rivals,\\ &phenomenal_bridge, claim_ceiling, ethical_posture,\\ &revision) \end{aligned}$$

The five regimes should be treated as a partially ordered family of operational hypotheses, not a scalar ladder of consciousness. A target may satisfy one operationalization of reflexive admissibility while failing another; a composite may have properties absent from its components; and an apparently self-modifying

system may merely optimize inside a fixed external envelope. The boundary, environment, timescale, and governing relation must therefore be explicit.

Matched interventions should compare ATC predictions against generic dynamical complexity, recurrent control, predictive processing, memory, language competence, task training, and observer attribution. Instrumentation can establish measured state, transition, perturbation response, and model fit. A phenomenal bridge requires additional theory and evidence. Ethical precaution may be warranted under uncertainty, but precaution is a decision policy rather than positive evidence of experience; absence of ATC evidence is likewise not evidence of absence.

The universal GSM can type
`INSTANTIATES_ATC_RESEARCH_TARGET`,
`EXHIBITS_ADMISSIBILITY_REGIME`, `COMPETES_WITH_RIVAL_EXPLANATION`,
`CROSSES_PHENOMENAL_BRIDGE_ONLY_BY_EVIDENCE`, `APPLIES_PRECAUTION_UNDER_UNCERTAINTY`,
`REFUSES_CONSCIOUSNESS_SCORE`, and
`DOES_NOT_INFER_MORAL_STATUS`.

This reverse-dependency review establishes four editorial commitments: adopt the bounded research-case record; treat ATC regimes as partial operational hypotheses rather than a scalar ranking; require matched rival explanations and explicit system boundaries; and preserve separate phenomenal, moral, legal, and deployment decision gates.

14. Expanded Counterevidence and Rival-Explanation Program

ATC is weakened, narrowed, or defeated within a declared scope if any of the following survives matched testing:

1. Admissibility descriptions can be drawn equally well around every lawful system and add no discriminating prediction beyond dynamics, complexity, control, or computation.
2. Boundary selection determines the apparent A_0-A_4 profile more strongly than properties of the target.
3. Candidate constraint representations are epiphenomenal: interventions on them do not change the predicted later decisions or effects.
4. Receipt feedback improves performance only by supplying ordinary memory, with no additional explanatory value from the admissibility vocabulary.
5. A simpler controller or causal graph predicts the same interventions without the ATC regime structure.
6. Report, access, metacognition, phenomenal presence, and phenomenal character cannot be operationally separated in the proposed studies.
7. Credible conscious cases lack a proposed necessary feature, or strongly supported nonconscious cases possess a proposed sufficient profile.
8. The phenomenal bridge moves after results are known, making negative evidence unable to count against it.

9. Organizational closure, reflexivity, or self-authorship tracks autonomy or governance but not consciousness once confounds are controlled.
10. Cross-scale composition fails: component profiles do not determine a composite profile, and no principled boundary or aggregation rule is supplied.
11. Meaning-binding terminology smuggles semantics into what the evidence establishes only as causal sensitivity.
12. GMB records remain internally coherent while their source custody, system boundaries, reports, evidence, or phenomenal interpretations are wrong.

The publication claim ceiling should therefore remain layered: structural description, causal organizational result, consciousness-relevant association, and phenomenal inference require distinct evidence and must not be promoted as one claim.

15. Publication Standing and Evidence Limits

Internal Corpus References Added by This Pass

[**I1**] Ableman Adam Ableman *Ableman Consciousness Ontology.* Exact author source,
SHA-256
`FC81C7FFA89CB3AAEA83B258BAA1ABE7AAE34A1944B44A3E5D620C35632494E0`.

[**I2**] Ableman Adam Ableman *Dynatology.* Exact author source,
SHA-256
`8539BBB8D636C406800A38C7EC47BE36B1EEEBFA04FAE062FF6E53137099BEFC`.

[**I3**] Ableman Adam Ableman *Semantic Reactor Theory.* Exact author source,
SHA-256
`4EDC285804FF431FF74A62014432A5E8BA3F33077364B989D5E219019A08D61F`.

[**I4**] Ableman Adam Ableman *Meaning-Inertia.* Exact author source,
SHA-256
`A188EFF52B861D781B6ECE50ABBDDD65D1D3C7E03E38F6A6A07716AEB8D232E4`.

[**I5**] Ableman Adam Ableman *The Locus of Qualia.* Exact author source,
SHA-256
`915D9EBFF4D698119A4E0F68A106E34A6486BBC99DE0FA93BE0EB7E105072459`.

[**I6**] Ableman Adam Ableman *The Locus of Meaning.* Exact author source,
SHA-256
`AC11630EA96DBFD08238C6717AD3CC5EADE57C98C3A4D50ACC52D9E71D5E148C`.

[**I7**] Ableman Adam Ableman *Meaning as Binding.* Exact author source,
SHA-256
`A9EA6370E77A71A997F1D1CAC18EF6213125C6F3E13BEEBC9F5E8BFB94FE0B45`.

[**I8**] Ableman Adam Ableman *The Well-Governed Mind.* Exact author source,
SHA-256
`E94A1667686262FFC639B18488E9517BDA1DA5ECF2FA4A92973B834B8F81643B`.

[**I9**] Ableman Adam Ableman *Integrating Semantic Manifold Topology.* Exact GMB documentation source,
SHA-256
`49A05A424F226A21C81D638727E1165DE1AD55AB1CBDC56EA65D67A1362A4B08`.

Reference-status note. These are internal corpus bindings. The original external references are retained as author material, but no external literature search, citation revalidation, empirical replication, consciousness adjudication, or implementation audit occurred in this pass.

Structural Hypothesis Without a Consciousness Verdict

Public orientation

Admissibility Theory of Consciousness proposes that constrained, reflexive continuation and meaning-binding may be useful dimensions in consciousness research. It does not establish that these dimensions are necessary, sufficient, unique, measurable by the proposed proxies, or present in any particular biological or artificial system.

Adversarial tests

1. **Proxy-circularity attack.** The study defines consciousness through the same organizational features it later measures. Outcomes must be reported as structural properties unless an independent phenomenal criterion exists.
2. **Rival-explanation attack.** Continuation, reflexivity, or closure may arise from control, memory, language, optimization, or task structure without phenomenality. Rival models need discriminating predictions.
3. **Multiple-realization overreach.** Substrate neutrality is inferred from abstract description alone. Cross-substrate comparison requires operational equivalence and cannot establish identical experience.
4. **Graded-to-binary collapse.** A continuous structural score is converted into a consciousness verdict or moral-status threshold. The paper prohibits this inference.
5. **Anthropomorphic benchmark attack.** Human-like language or self-report is treated as privileged evidence. Reports, behavior, architecture, intervention response, and uncertainty must remain distinct evidence classes.
6. **Negative-inference attack.** Failure to satisfy the proposed profile is treated as evidence of absence. It may instead reflect a bad proxy, inaccessible mechanism, or domain mismatch.
7. **Ethical-standing laundering.** A research score grants or removes rights, welfare standing, or deployment authority. Those are separate ethical and institutional decisions.

Evidence and citation gate

The paper can publish as a bounded theoretical research program only if it distinguishes definitions, hypotheses, operational proxies, rival explanations, tests, and prohibited inferences. Claims about neuroscience, philosophy of mind, animal consciousness, clinical states, or machine consciousness require current external literature and qualified review. Internal corpus coherence is not external validation.

No external research was performed in this pass. The current candidate therefore retains an external-evidence and domain-review gate. Synthetic or architectural demonstrations may test the workbench; they cannot provide phenomenal evidence.

Formalization decision

Equations should encode a measurement protocol or discriminating prediction, not turn a philosophical hypothesis into a theorem by notation. Scores must expose components, weights, calibration population, uncertainty, and non-inference rules.

16. Conclusion

Admissibility offers a place to begin below the familiar human bundle: constrained continuation before representation, consequential distinction before semantics, and persistence before reflective self-description. ATC proposes that cognition and consciousness-relevant organization can be investigated as increasingly reflexive arrangements of that common structure.

The price of this breadth is precision. Admissible does not mean actual. Physically possible does not mean authorized. Updating evidence does not necessarily amend a rule. A feedback loop does not establish organizational closure, an audit trail does not establish internal awareness, and self-authorship is not a compulsory measure of consciousness.

The resulting project is nevertheless constructive. Dynatology supplies a formal grammar; ACO supplies comparison dimensions; SRT supplies a candidate architecture for governed recursive continuation; Meaning–Inertia remains a separate physical hypothesis. Their intersection yields an object that can be specified and perturbed without first settling machine consciousness or universal experience.

The question is no longer how many human-like capacities must accumulate before a label is awarded. It is **which organizations of admissibility make the relevant difference, at what scale, under which interventions, and with what independent evidence**. That is the work required to turn a shared structural kernel into an explanatory theory.

Editorial Provenance and Standing

Source, Evidence, and Standing

This is an AI-prepared successor revision candidate derived from one exact author manuscript. The integration custody manifest is `work/paper-saturation-v1/evidence/admissibility-theory-consciousness/integration-custody-manifest.v0.1.json`, SHA-256 `FDEFBAC0DDA7FE9BF31A669C657EB4C341F3FCD676B2C81A40D9545AD8FC879D`. The selected file is named `Ableman_Consciousness_Ontology_REVISED_CANDIDATE.md`, but its internal title and entire content identify it as *Admissibility Theory of Consciousness*. A second file named `Admissibility_Theory_of_Consciousness_CANDIDATE.md` is byte-identical. Both exact paths remain unchanged. This pass records that custody fact without inferring permission to rename files or merge logical works. The ATC thesis, formal distinctions, five regimes, closure analysis, Semantic Reactor Theory interpretation, phenomenal bridge, literature positioning, research program, and original caveats are author material. This pass standardizes the paper surface, repairs the mistaken internal `[ACO]` custody reference, supplies the complete realization funnel, adds GMB and universal-GSM placement, strengthens corpus relationships and countertests, and creates an author-decision surface. Those changes are AI editorial or synthetic contributions until adopted. The source cites external literature and reports one published empirical result concerning inner speech. This pass conducted no external research and did not independently revalidate any citation, empirical result, or novelty comparison. The paper remains a formal and conceptual research program. It does not classify any human, animal, artificial system, component, or composite as conscious and does not establish phenomenality by definition.

Corpus-Wide Reference Positioning

This paper argues that consciousness debates often promote familiar capacities of human minds into necessary conditions while leaving the underlying organization unspecified. Its nearest external comparison fields are formal, consciousness, semantic. The sources in [E1], [E2], [E3], [E4], [E5], [E6], [E7] are cited as predecessor literature, adjacent standards, or counterpressure - not as evidence that they caused the Ableman framework or that they validate its novel claims. The comparison isolates where established work already supplies provenance, formal assurance, institutional constraint, empirical method, or engineering practice, and where this paper adds a distinct claim about admissibility, authority, semantic custody, or governed realization.

Within the Ableman corpus, the highest-priority current cross-links are [A1],

[A2], [A3], [A4], [A5], [A6], [A7]. These are links among separately custodied works, not silent identity mergers. Their role is to expose mutual dependencies, terminology collisions, and places where a reader should traverse the corpus before treating this paper as self-sufficient.

Reference-pass counterevidence and limit search

The pass applied the following pressure tests: Formal assurance remains relative to the encoded model, trusted base, and refinement chain; proof does not remove specification error or unmodeled environmental behavior. Structural and computational correspondences remain insufficient as phenomenal evidence unless linked to discriminating empirical predictions against competing theories. Formal vocabularies and graph links make commitments explicit but cannot by themselves establish correct identity, shared interpretation, or lossless translation between contexts. These limits are not generic disclaimers: they identify the assumptions that a later empirical, formal, or implementation review must try to break.

Reference-pass influence and novelty boundary

No newly added external source is asserted to be a documented authorial influence unless the predecessor source already said so. `Predecessor` means earlier relevant work;

`adjacent` means a useful comparison; `standard` means an interoperability or assurance baseline; and `counterevidence` marks work that narrows or pressures a claim. Novelty therefore remains a reviewable, claim-level question rather than an inference from a low similarity score or an absent citation.

References

External scholarship, standards, and prior art

[**E1**] George C. Necula. "Proof-Carrying Code." *POPL '97*, 1997, pp. 106-119. DOI: 10.1145/263699.263712. https://doi.org/10.1145/263699.263712 **Relationship:** Predecessor for binding machine-checkable evidence to executable artifacts; the present paper may demand broader semantic or constitutional obligations.

[**E2**] Xavier Leroy. "Formal Verification of a Realistic Compiler." *Communications of the ACM* 52(7), 2009, pp. 107-115. DOI: 10.1145/1538788.1538814. https://doi.org/10.1145/1538788.1538814 **Relationship:** Predecessor verified-compilation result used to distinguish proven translation preservation from broader governance claims.

[**E3**] Patrick Cousot and Radhia Cousot. "Abstract Interpretation: A Unified Lattice Model for Static Analysis of Programs by Construction or Approximation of Fixpoints." *POPL '77*, 1977. DOI: 10.1145/512950.512973.

https://doi.org/10.1145/512950.512973 **Relationship:** Predecessor formal framework for sound approximation and fixpoint reasoning.

[**E4**] Leslie Lamport. *Specifying Systems: The TLA+ Language and Tools for Hardware and Software Engineers*. Addison-Wesley, 2002. https://lamport.azurewebsites.net/tla/book.html **Relationship:** Predecessor specification discipline for state machines, safety, liveness, and refinement.

[**E5**] David J. Chalmers. "Facing Up to the Problem of Consciousness." *Journal of Consciousness Studies* 2(3), 1995, pp. 200-219. https://consc.net/papers/facing.html **Relationship:** Foundational framing of the explanatory gap; cited to bound, not resolve, phenomenal claims.

[**E6**] Larissa Albantakis et al. "Integrated Information Theory (IIT) 4.0: Formulating the Properties of Phenomenal Existence in Physical Terms." *PLOS Computational Biology* 19(10), 2023, e1011465. DOI: 10.1371/journal.pcbi.1011465. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pcbi.1011465 **Relationship:** Competing formal theory of consciousness included for explicit contrast and counterevidence obligations.

[**E7**] Stanislas Dehaene and Jean-Pierre Changeux. "Experimental and Theoretical Approaches to Conscious Processing." *Neuron* 70(2), 2011, pp. 200-227. DOI: 10.1016/j.neuron.2011.03.018. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.neuron.2011.03.018 **Relationship:** Competing global-workspace account included to prevent a corpus-native ontology from substituting for empirical neuroscience.

Ableman corpus

[**A1**] Adam Ableman. *MCIR: A Canonical Intermediate Representation for Governed Transformation*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity `PAPER.PUB.21095303`;
source SHA-256
`EA129ECBA95F7B07CAA7B33A54F91F52913C94A14DA227EB9A06CFD083E4E5BF`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A2**] Adam Ableman. *Governed Semantic Compilation*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity `PAPER.PUB.18453681`;
source SHA-256
`5FF6C636550B04DB0E2F6F94C379BB75AA0BD8781E19B047D7D3BB6D49071AC2`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A3**] Adam Ableman. *Hybrid Semantic Compiler Architectures*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity `PAPER.PUB.21228038`;
source SHA-256
`EBCD6DDDA9B547639AEBED79FB68069473CF1248E41C527B48C9624BBE2C0496`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A4**] Adam Ableman. *Admissibility Engineering.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-F1E33B5E973B0900`;
source SHA-256
`CDC80271268802CA5CB4DE3624B992FB2FF07D677BF945C4B349BD307C4C2A6E`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A5**] Adam Ableman. *Everything Is a Compiler.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-30FB8F95BD990A47`;
source SHA-256
`FE0F88A1F125317285BE4378E5F27ACC9FEB83ADE3FF329A3DA9F9CB026DF9A9`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A6**] Adam Ableman. *Ableman Consciousness Ontology (ACO).* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity `PAPER.PUB.18203749`;
source SHA-256
`ACD97032780DA7B3A36750702BE1F47BCB2E6361EF6E74ECA8B441D7C6A25DDE`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A7**] Adam Ableman. *The Locus of Qualia.* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-AF27E66B81811DB1`;
source SHA-256
`7B83EBD0FFDCFEBFA522A715AE0E4D1049FCA0B4CE0618C2017F8BB9206E5424`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

Ableman Corpus references

Author manuscripts supplied for this paper

[**D**] Ableman Adam Ableman *Dynatology: A Science of Structured Potentiality.* Supplied manuscript, `Dynatology.md`; undated. Section citations refer to the supplied text, not a published edition.

[**ACO**] Ableman Adam Ableman *Ableman Consciousness Ontology (ACO): Consciousness as a Manifold of Meaning-Binding, Causal Organization, Situational Awareness, and Epistemic Self-Authorship.* Supplied author manuscript,
`Ableman_Consciousness_Ontology.md`; exact SHA-256
`FC81C7FFA89CB3AAEA83B258BAA1ABE7AAE34A1944B44A3E5D620C35632494E0`.
This source is distinct from the filename-misaligned ATC manuscript revised here.

[**MI**] Ableman Adam Ableman *Meaning–Inertia: An Ontological Substrate Beneath Inertia, Gravitation, and Spacetime*. Supplied manuscript, `Meaning--Inertia-v2.md`; undated. Treated as a candidate hypothesis, not confirmed physics.

[**SRT**] Ableman Adam Ableman *Semantic Reactor Theory: Governance-Native Architecture for High-Authority Semantic Transformation Systems*. Supplied manuscript, `Semantic Reactor Theory.md`; undated. Architectural definitions and proposed results are attributed to that source; no independent implementation audit is implied.

External literature

Albantakis, L., et al. (2023). Integrated information theory (IIT) 4.0: Formulating the properties of phenomenal existence in physical terms. *PLOS Computational Biology, 19*(10), e1011465. DOI: 10.1371/journal.pcbi.1011465.

Ashby, W. R. (1956). *An Introduction to Cybernetics*. Chapman & Hall. Selected original-text passages consulted in the transcription "Cybernetics and Requisite Variety"; editorial commentary on that page is not used.

Desmet, R., and Irvine, A. D. (2022 revision). Alfred North Whitehead. *Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*. Scholarly secondary source used to check the interpretation of Whitehead's metaphysics; not represented as a primary experimental source.

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Maturana, H. R., and Varela, F. J. (1980). *Autopoiesis and Cognition: The Realization of the Living*. D. Reidel. DOI: 10.1007/978-94-009-8947-4.

Montevil, M., and Mossio, M. (2015). Biological organisation as closure of constraints. *Journal of Theoretical Biology, 372*, 179–191. DOI: 10.1016/j.jtbi.2015.02.029. Author-hosted full text consulted.

Nedergaard, J. S. K., and Lupyan, G. (2024). Not everybody has an inner voice: Behavioral consequences of anendophasia. *Psychological Science, 35*(7). DOI: 10.1177/09567976241243004.

Varela, F. J., Thompson, E., and Rosch, E. (1991/2017). *The Embodied Mind: Cognitive Science and Human Experience*. MIT Press. Original publication 1991; revised edition 2017. Publisher description and edition information consulted.

Whitehead, A. N. (1929). *Process and Reality*. Macmillan. Interpretation here is supported through the supplied ACO lineage and Desmet and Irvine's scholarly discussion, not a newly completed reading of the entire primary text.

Corpus source and companion formats: https://github.com/AblemanMosaic/ableman-corpus
License: CC-BY-ND-4.0

DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.23847372